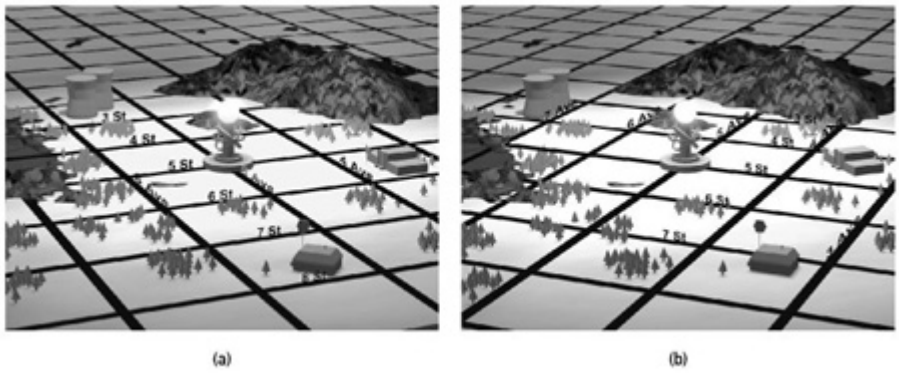


Figure 3.2 **(**a**)** Marge’s street design. **(**b**)** Lisa’s street design.

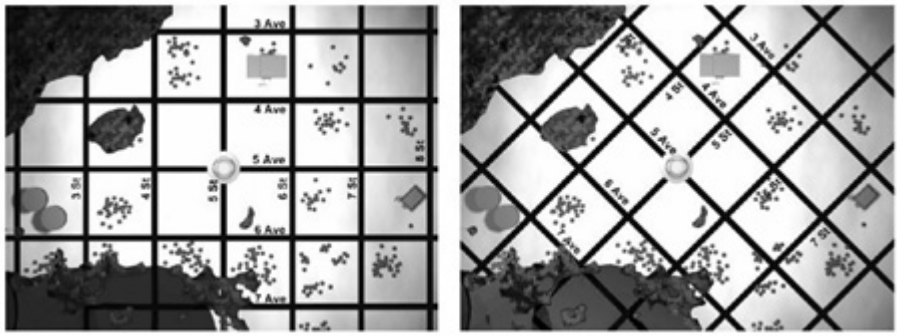


Figure 3.2 **(**c**)** Overview of Marge’s and Lisa’s street/avenue designs. Their grids differ by a rotation.

Now, following the insight of Einstein’s mathematics professor Hermann Minkowski (who once called his young student a lazy dog), consider the region of spacetime as an entity unto itself: consider the complete flip book as an object in its own right. To do so, imagine that, as in Figure 3.3b, we expand the binding of the flip-card book and then imagine that, as in Figure 3.3c, all the pages are completely transparent, so when you look at the book you see one continuous block containing all the events that happened during a given time interval. From this perspective, the pages should be thought of as simply providing a convenient way of organizing the content of the block—that is, of organizing the events of spacetime. Just as a street/avenue grid allows us to specify locations in a city easily, by giving their street and avenue address, the division of the spacetime block into pages allows us to easily specify an event (Itchy shooting his gun, Scratchy being hit, and so on) by giving the time when the event occurred—the page on which it appears—and the location within the region of space depicted on the pages.